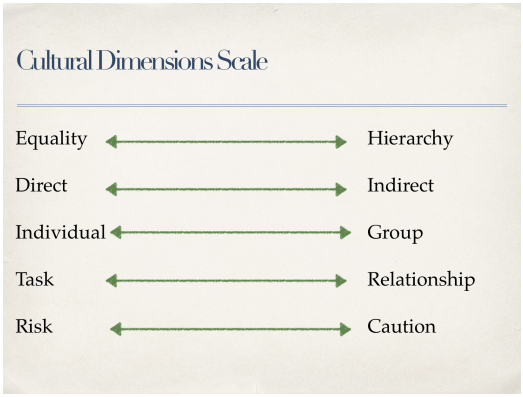
Cultural Dimension Scale Worksheet



Identify the Cultural Dimension Scale that applies in each of the following:

Scale: ……..
Marcela is a Mexican female who immigrated to the United States at age 14 and hides an attraction to other women from her friends and family. She has been raised in the tradition of machista, believing that women should be submissive to men and become wives and mothers, so she feels conflict over her attraction to women and afraid of her family finding out. She has been talking to other female-attracted girls online, to avoid being seen with one in public, and recently connected with a girlfriend named Michelle; Michelle pressures her to come out to her family about her sexuality and "break free" from what Michelle sees as oppressive gender roles. Marcela is reluctant to do so, because she has seen women in her culture condemned for breaking machista.

Scale: ……..
Ranjan, a 21-year-old Indian student, and Suzanne, and 22-year-old German student, began dating six months ago after meeting in their American school's student exchange program. Suzanne likes that Ranjan is kind and romantic, but she is beginning to feel frustrated because their relationship is much the same as it was when they first began dating; their dates are the same as they were six months ago, and they still only kiss despite their friends having sex after only two or three months of dating. Ranjan enjoys showing Suzanne that he cares by making romantic gestures, getting to know her favourite things, and being available when she wants support, and he dislikes the pressure he feels when she keeps asking about "taking the next step."

Scale: ……..
Kun is a 16-year-old first-generation Chinese-American whose parents recently noticed him holding hands with another boy. Both his parents have been asking if he likes any girls and suggesting girls for him meet with. Kun can tell that they are concerned about him being gay and not carrying on the family line. He has told them that he deserves his privacy and that he

should be able to choose his social relations; they stop talking to him when he expresses these concerns, but later tell him that their family has a long history and describe the ways they honour their ancestors.

Scale: ……..
François, 15, is visiting relatives in the United States from his home in Haiti to improve his English over the summer. In his relatives' home, all the children as well as the adults are expected to clean up the house and do all other chores whenever they have the time to do something that they see needs to be done. At his home in Haiti, François is used to having set chores for each person, strongly divided into "girls' work" and "boys' work," and answering to his parents regarding the chores getting done. François is upset that he has to do "girls' work" and confused by the idea of being left to his own initiative when seeing that the garbage needs to be taken out or that the evening meal should be started.

Scale: ……..
Ronny, 25, identifies as female and has recently started hormone therapy for her male-to-female transition; she has also recently started a sexual relationship with Danilee, also 25, a cisgender girl. Danilee has only had sex with cisgender girls in the past and is unsure how Ronny wants her male-bodied genitals to be touched and pleasured sexually. Ronny is not completely comfortable discussing her changing body and will often say things like "touch me softly" without specifying which parts of her body. Danilee is getting frustrated and feels insecure because she does not seem to be able to satisfy her girlfriend, but Ronny is not giving clearer directions.

Scale: ……..
Danilee is the 16-year-old Euro-American daughter of two Navy officers, and considers herself lesbian. She told her parents of her support for the repeal of Don't Ask, Don't Tell, and they angrily told her that it should have stayed in place because "queers" don't deserve the right to defend the country. Danilee feels rejected by her parents and that she must hide a major part of herself from them, and she has few friends for support due to her family moving frequently. After the argument with her family, she got drunk at a party and had sex with a boy in a back room to try to "fix" herself, and her period is late.

Scale: ……..
Anna is a Euro-American girl who cross dresses with a rolled-up sock in her trousers, but considers herself cisgender and straight. She has bought several shirts, ties, and other articles of men's clothing from a thrift store and hides them, afraid that her actively Catholic parents, brother, or neighbours and friends will find out. She doesn't know why it feels good to dress and present as male (to herself only), and she worries that God will punish her; she is afraid to mention her cross-dressing at confession, for fear that she will be told to stop.